

Method of disposing solid waste by households

Table 11.17: Percentage Distribution of Households by the Main Method of Disposing Solid Waste, 2024

Method of disposing solid waste	Sri Lanka	Sector			
		Urban	Estate-Urban	Rural	Estate-Rural
Total number of households	6,111,315	1,042,557	3,108	4,827,055	238,595
Disposal of easy decaying waste					
Total	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
By the local authority	23.9	81.9	43.0	12.4	2.7
Occupants burn	34.2	8.4	28.2	39.7	35.7
Occupants dispose within the premises	34.5	6.3	13.4	40.4	38.0
Composing solid waste	5.6	2.5	6.0	6.1	7.8
Dispose into Road/River/Canal/Sea/Lagoon/Forest	0.5	0.2	4.1	0.2	9.1
Provide to the waste collectors	0.9	0.5	3.3	0.9	3.3
Other	0.4	0.2	2.0	0.3	3.5
Disposal of polythene and plastic					
Total	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
By the local authority	25.3	84.1	39.1	13.8	2.0
Occupants burn	52.5	10.0	43.7	61.1	61.0
Occupants dispose within the premises	12.3	2.5	5.8	14.2	18.7
Dispose into Road/River/Canal/Sea/Lagoon/Forest	0.4	0.1	3.5	0.2	7.0
Provide to the waste collectors	9.0	3.1	6.9	10.2	8.8
Other	0.5	0.2	1.0	0.5	2.5
Disposal of electronic waste					
Total	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
By the local authority	24.5	80.4	39.7	13.5	2.5
Occupants burn	12.8	3.0	12.7	14.6	18.9
Occupants dispose within the premises	19.1	3.1	7.2	22.2	25.7
Dispose into Road/River/Canal/Sea/Lagoon/Forest	0.6	0.2	2.7	0.3	7.9
Provide to the waste collectors	41.1	12.8	36.4	47.4	40.5
Other	1.9	0.5	1.3	2.0	4.5
Disposal glass cuttings/bottles					
Total	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
By the local authority	24.3	79.6	41.2	13.4	2.6
Occupants dispose within the premises	25.8	5.0	13.9	29.8	36.2
Dispose into Road/River/Canal/Sea/Lagoon/Forest	0.9	0.2	3.3	0.7	8.9
Provide to the waste collectors	47.5	14.8	40.4	54.5	48.5
Other	1.5	0.4	1.2	1.6	3.8
Disposal of other (Metal, tin, rubber etc.)					
Total	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
By the local authority	22.8	76.8	35.5	12.2	2.5
Occupants burn	8.4	2.1	9.0	9.5	13.7
Occupants dispose within the premises	13.1	2.3	3.1	15.1	18.1
Dispose into Road/River/Canal/Sea/Lagoon/Forest	0.6	0.2	2.4	0.4	6.9
Provide to the waste collectors	54.0	18.3	48.8	61.7	55.8
Other	1.1	0.3	1.2	1.1	3.0

Information on solid waste disposal was collected by classifying methods into five main categories. Regarding biodegradable (easily decomposable) waste, the most adopted method among households in